

Silent Night at the Haunted School

A first-person horror RPG in which a bullied student is locked inside his school on the night the dead return.

MY ROLE

Design team · Team manager

FOCUS

Narrative · world · character

TEAM

Four collaborators

BUILD

Unity · Maya · C#



Nighttime atmosphere study used on the project page.

The player’s voice becomes the risk.

Paul is forced to spend the night at school with the three classmates who bully him. After curfew, the ghosts wake. He must solve the building’s puzzles and reach an exit while discovering why he may have been brought there.

“The silent survive. The screaming perish.”

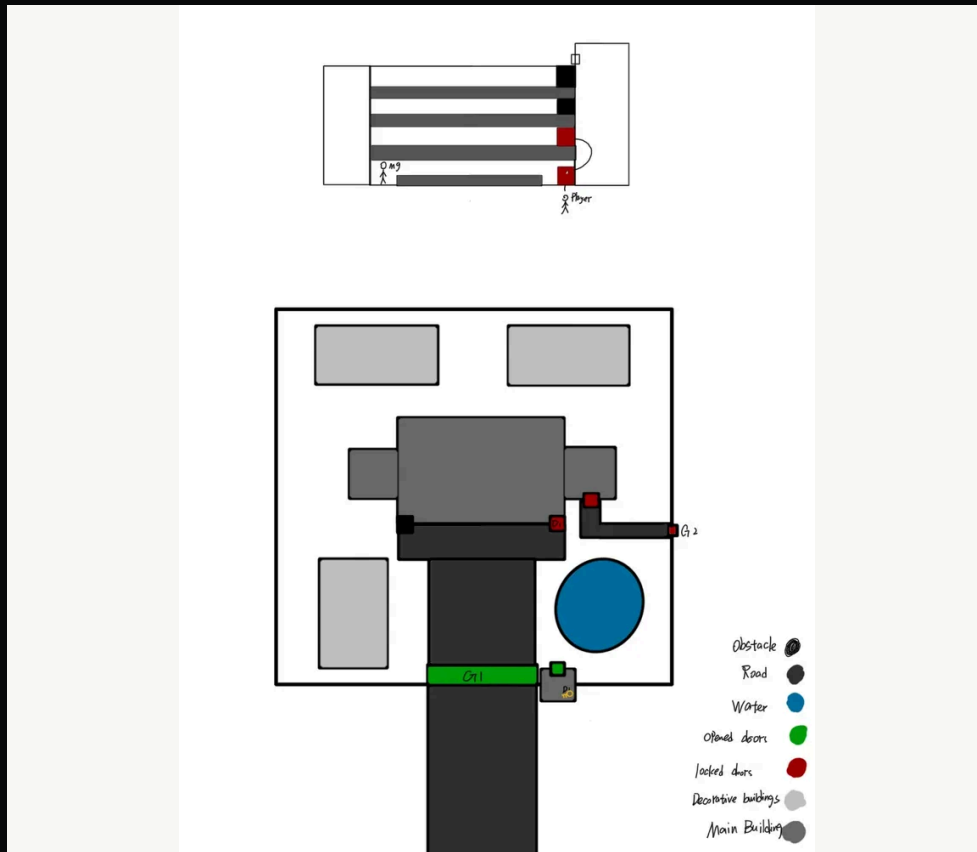
From the game’s opening narration

THE CORE INTERACTION

A live microphone makes fear consequential. Several spirits respond to sound rather than sight, so a scream can change the encounter instead of merely expressing it.

01	Explore	Read the school and its locked routes.
02	Listen	Use sound as a warning of nearby danger.
03	Stay quiet	Avoid drawing the spirits closer.
04	Escape	Resolve the puzzles and leave the building.

A school that **gates** escape.



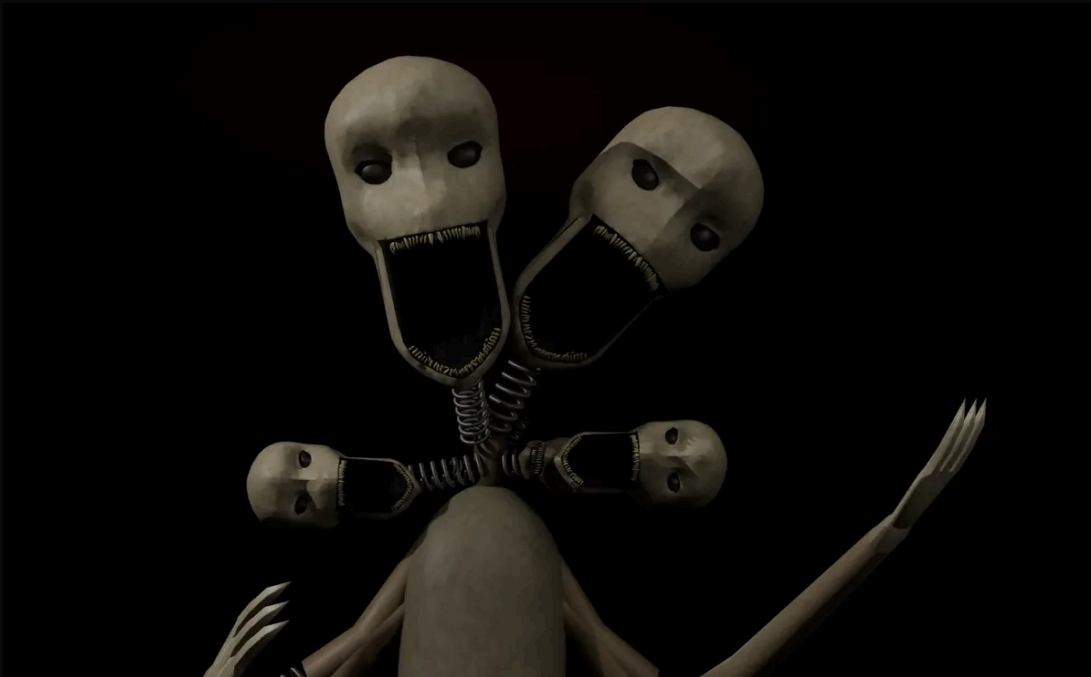
Early level map. Red marks locked doors; green marks opened doors.

FROM STORY RULE TO SPATIAL RULE

The curfew traps the cast in a familiar building made hostile. The map connects the locker corridor to the courtyard through obstacles and doors that change state, turning movement through school into a sequence of decisions.

Thresholds	Locked doors hold back progress until the route is understood.
Exposure	Open space and tight corridors create different kinds of vulnerability.
Memory	Repeated paths let players learn the building while conditions change.

The haunting has **rules.**



Main Ghost character model. The four heads make the figure identifiable before the player can read its intent.

A former student, bullied by the same group, guides Paul toward the truth - but attacks when he screams instead of listening.

Main Ghost

Roams freely; guidance and danger come from the same figure.

Ghost in the Painting

Moves between frames; strikes if the player stops watching.

Ghost in the Mirror

Appears in reflections; closes in under a prolonged stare.

Ghost in the Hole

Waits in dark corners; a scream makes him faster.

Borrow the **principle**, not the scene.

The team drew from horror games and folklore to define tension, pacing and the school's supernatural rules.

Threat & evidence

Phasmophobia ↗

Spirits that reveal themselves through traces and behaviour, reworked for a single-player story.

Five Nights at Freddy's ↗

Survival tension when a threat cannot simply be defeated.

Pacing & tone

Doki Doki Literature Club! ↗

An ordinary setup that slowly reveals a darker story underneath.

Visage ↗

Atmosphere and anticipation carrying a scene before any scripted shock.

Setting & folklore

Hungry Ghost Festival

The Ghost Month setting supplied the calendar hook and curfew rule.

Mirror & painting stories

Folklore about haunted images informed two spirits' encounter rules.

Linked titles open source pages in the PDF. The folklore entries describe the team's research themes, not a single source.

Design first. Then build.

A MOVING TEAM STRUCTURE

The team divided into design and technical work, with people transitioning as the project progressed. My role moved from narrative, world and character design into Unity implementation from week 9.

Tools	Maya, Unity and C#
Assets	Shared through Google Drive
Code	GitHub with agreed commit conventions
Cadence	Weekly beta builds and regular team meetings

WEEKS 4-6

Design first

Three members focused on characters, world and story while the technical foundation began.

WEEKS 6-9

Transition

Design members moved to the technical team in stages, keeping implementation staffed.

WEEKS 9-13

Full build

All four members worked on implementation and weekly testing toward the final build.

Make the fear **consensual**.

A bullying story with microphone input needs safeguards alongside its dramatic ideas.

01 Age gate

18+ rating and a warning before play, so the subject matter is clear in advance.

02 Player wellbeing

Warnings for jump scares and photosensitive content, plus a planned reduced-horror option.

03 Cultural context

The Hungry Ghost Festival is presented as a real tradition, with in-game context rather than caricature.

04 Microphone consent

Explicit permission before listening; a button-based alternative for players who decline.

Safeguards described here reflect the group's design plan; this page does not claim that every option was shipped.

From the story's logic to the **player's route**.

My contribution connected the game's narrative, visual identity and spatial rules before I moved into implementation.

Narrative

Backstories for Paul, the bullies and the bound spirits.

World

School layout, Ghost Festival curfew and movement routes.

Character

Main Ghost modelling and art direction in Maya.

Production

Meeting rhythm, handovers and later Unity work.

CASE-STUDY NOTE

The most important design move was making the story's silence rule playable: the microphone turns the player's own reaction into part of the risk.



Explore the project

github.com/em05niper/Group-Project-Repository

Project stage: in-engine build in progress. Images shown here are the available project-page studies and model, not a claim of a finished release.